



MGMT 579 – Leading across Cultures
Spring, 2025

Instructor: Professor Xiao-Ping Chen

Class Hours: Tuesdays 6:00pm – 9:30pm

Classroom: Paccar 392

Office Hours: Tuesdays 4:30-5:30pm. I am also happy to meet one-on-one in person or by Zoom. Please don't hesitate to email me if you would like to do this.

Office: Paccar 511

E-mail: xpchen@uw.edu

Course Website: <http://canvas.uw.edu>

INSTRUCTOR

Xiao-Ping Chen (xpchen@uw.edu) is Philip M. Condit Endowed Chair Professor in Business Administration at the Michael G. Foster School of Business, University of Washington. She has served as Associate Dean for Faculty and Academic Affairs (2016-2020) and Chair of the Department of Management and Organization (2009-2015) at Foster. She is an elected Fellow in Academy of Management (AOM) and American Psychological Association (APA). Professor Chen has served as Editor-in-Chief for *Organizational Behavior and Human Decision Processes* (2010-2016). Currently she is the Editor-in-Chief of *Management and Organization Review*, and Executive Editor of *Management Insights*, a bilingual (Chinese and English) magazine for business educators and practitioners. Professor Chen received her Ph.D. from University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign and served as a faculty member previously at Indiana University and Hong Kong University of Science and Technology. She was also a distinguished visiting professor at University of Cambridge, INSEAD, Fudan University, Peking University, Kobe University, Indian School of Business, University of Hong Kong, Hong Kong Baptist University, National University of Singapore, Nanyang Technological University, Zhejiang University, and China Europe International Business School.

<https://thewholeu.uw.edu/2024/05/24/people-of-uw-xiao-ping-chen/>

<https://foster.uw.edu/faculty-research/directory/xiao-ping-chen/>

Teaching Assistant

Robert Chico (rchico@uw.edu) is a Ph.D. student in the area of OBHRM at Foster School of Business. His main research interests include employee voice, gender and leadership, mentorship, and research methods. <https://foster.uw.edu/academics/degree-programs/phd-program/directory/robert-chico/>

Course Overview:

Since the last century, organizations have been internationalizing their operations aggressively to take advantage of technology advancements and global resource accessibility. Even with the challenge of the pandemic and the rhetoric of de-globalization, the number of enterprises conducting business across national borders has increased. Whether these global enterprises are capable of planning and managing a nationally and culturally diverse workforce becomes one key determining factor for their survival and success.

This course aims to provide students with a working knowledge of cross-cultural management as well as theoretical and analytical tools to make sound management decisions in an international setting. This course will prepare students to become effective global managers by (a) providing useful theoretical frameworks to help students organize their observation and experience in coherent ways, (b) expanding students' mind with more perspectives to view human motivation, cognition, and behavior, and (c) learning effective skills in intercultural communication, negotiation, multicultural team building, and global leadership.

A range of participative learning methods will be used to facilitate an active classroom environment (e.g., case study, team projects, experiential exercises, group discussion, role playing, self-assessment, and guest speakers).

Course Schedule and Deliverables

This schedule is tentative. Because the amount of time required to cover each topic tends to vary, topics may be changed or omitted depending on our progress throughout the quarter.

Date	Topics	Required readings and videos (available on Canvas)
April 1 (Tuesday) 6:00-9:30pm	Week 1 Course introduction: Syllabus (de)Globalization and cross-cultural management Understanding cultural differences: culture quiz and value orientations Project Group Formation	Global flows: The ties that bind in an interconnected world (2022). https://www.mckinsey.com/capabilities/strategy-and-corporate-finance/our-insights/global-flows-the-ties-that-bind-in-an-interconnected-world Geopolitics and the geometry of global trade: 2025 update. McKinsey. https://www.mckinsey.com/~media/mckinsey/mckinsey%20global%20institute/our%20research/geopolitics%20and%20the%20geometry%20of%20global%20trade%202025%20update/geopolitics-and-the-geometry-of-global-trade-2025-update.pdf?shouldIndex=false Gupta A.K., & Govindarajan, V. (2002). Cultivating a global mindset. https://journals.aom.org/doi/full/10.5465/ame.2002.6640211 The secret life of social norms Michele Gelfand (Ted Talk on culture tightness-looseness) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oqkzp9C2Vyl Optional: Hofstede, G. (1991). Levels of Culture (Chapter 1 in the book of <i>Cultures and Organizations: Software of the Mind</i> , pp. 3-18). Triandis, H. C. (1995). Attributes of Individualism and Collectivism (Chapter 3 in the book of <i>Individualism & Collectivism</i> , pp. 34-80).
After class Homework: Watch documentary film (2019): <i>American Factory</i> (Netflix) https://www.netflix.com/title/81090071		

Date	Topics	Required readings and videos (available on Canvas)
April 8 (Tuesday) 6:00-9:30pm	Week 2 Bridging Cross-cultural Communication gap: Context of communication Analysis of <i>American Factory</i>	Osland, J. & Bird, A. (2000). Beyond sophisticated stereotypes. https://journals.aom.org/doi/abs/10.5465/ame.2000.2909840 Lewis, R. D. (2004). Bridging the communication gap (Chapter 7 of the book <i>When Cultures Collide</i> , pp. 95-114). Cross cultural communication Pellegrino Riccardi (curiosity) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YMMyofREc5Jk Optional: Adair, W., Buchan, N., Chen, X.P., & Liu, D. (2016). A model of communication context and measure of context dependence.

		https://journals.aom.org/doi/abs/10.5465/amd.2014.0018 Power pose by Amy Cuddy (Ted Talk). https://www.ted.com/talks/amy_cuddy_your_body_language_may_shape_who_you_are/comments
After class Homework: 1. Communication style assessment: icEdge. Please download your personal and group profile 2. Read case: Netflix Going Global (Hastings, R., & Meyer, E. 2020. <i>No Rules Rules</i>, Chapter 10, Bring it to the World!) 3. Read case: Leading across cultures at Michelin (A)(B)		

Date	Topics	Required readings and videos (available on Canvas)
April 15 (Tuesday) 6:00-9:30pm	Week 3 Bridging intercultural communication gap Case discussion: Netflix goes global Leading across cultures at Michelin (A)(B) Briefing on icEdge Team Exercise: Group Communication Effectiveness Strategy	The culture map by Erin Meyer https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TE6bflq8LGw Relationship building via team communication: in-person vs. virtual by Buchan, Chen, Adair, Zhang https://foster.uw.edu/research-brief/work-relationships-hard-build-zoom-unless-pick-colleagues-nonverbal-cues/ The new science of building great teams. By Alex (Sandy) Pentland. HBR https://globalioc.com/wp-content/uploads/2019/01/The-New-Science-of-Team-Building.pdf Optional: What is normal? How culture affects communication styles? (an interview with Michele Gelfand) https://www.gsb.stanford.edu/insights/what-normal-how-culture-affects-communication-styles
After class Homework: Group assignment: Complete your strategy and action plan for group communication effectiveness Choose your group movie for the movie project		
Date	Topics	Required readings and videos (available on Canvas)
April 22 (Tuesday) 6:00-9:30pm	Week 4 Group communication effectiveness:	Adler & Gundersen, 2008. Negotiating Globally (Chapter 6 of the book <i>International Dimensions of Organizational Behavior</i>) The walk from “no” to “yes” (Ted Talk) by William Ury https://www.ted.com/talks/william_ury_the_walk_from_no_to_yes?language=en

	Sharing Team Strategies Team exercise: Cross-cultural negotiation simulation (Alpha-Beta)	Cultural difference in business Valerie Hoeks (building relationship) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VMwjscSCcf0 Optional: Chinese guanxi 1. Chen, X. P., & Chen, C. C. (2004). On the intricacies of Chinese guanxi: A process model of guanxi development. <i>Asia Pacific Journal of Management</i>, 21 (3), 305-324. 2. Chen, X. P., & Chen, C. C. (2012). Chinese Guanxi: The good, the bad, and the controversial. In X. Huang & M. Bond (Ed.), <i>Handbook of Chinese Organizational Behavior: Integrating Theory, Research, and Practice</i>. 425-435. Edward Elgar Publishing Limited. 3. Chen, C. C., Chen, X. P., & Huang, S. S. (2013). Guanxi and Social Network Research: Review and Future Directions. <i>Management and Organization Review</i>, 9(1), 167-207. The power of listening (Ted Talk) by William Ury https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=saXfavo1OQo
After class Homework: 1. Reflection essay on Alpha-Beta 2. Read Case: Unpacking the layers of diversity & inclusion in multicultural teams		

Date	Topics	Required readings and videos (available on Canvas)
April 29 (Tuesday) 6:00-9:30pm	Week 5 Building a Multicultural Team Problems with and potential of Multicultural Teams Case discussion: Unpacking the layers of diversity & inclusion in multicultural teams	Pucik, Bjorkman, (2023). Harnessing diversity in teams (Chapter 8 of the book <i>The Global Challenge</i>, pp. 278-313). Riding the waves of culture: Fons Trompenaars (connecting viewpoints) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hmyfjKjcbm0 Xiao-Ping's lecture on team diversity (recording on canvas) Optional: Harrison, D. A., & Klein, K. J. (2007). What's the difference? Diversity constructs as separation, variety, or disparity in organizations. <i>Academy of Management Review</i>. Tenzer, H., & Pudelko, M. (2017). The influence of language differences on power dynamics in multinational teams. <i>Journal of World Business</i>, 52(1), 45-61. https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/abs/pii/S1090951616301730
After class Homework: Group assignment: • Movie project preparation (watch the movie of your choice, discuss what cultural dimensions are most relevant to analyze the movie, prepare PPT presentation)		

Date	Topics	Required readings and videos (submit your PPT deck on Canvas)
May 6 (Tuesday) 6:00-9:30pm	Week 6 Team presentation of movie project	
After class Homework: Group assignment: Revising your strategies and plans for effective group communication		

Date	Topics	Required readings and videos (available on Canvas)
May 13 (Tuesday) 6:00-9:30pm	Week 7 International HRM Guest speaker: John Gleason, Assistant VP -- Costco International	Pfeffer & Viegas, 1999. Putting people first for organizational success. CNBC. (2019). <i>The Costco Craze: Inside the Warehouse Giant</i> . https://www.cnbc.com/the-costco-craze-inside-the-warehouse-giant . Chen, X. P. (2021). The cheapest and happiest company in the world and its internationalization – An interview with Mr. James Murphy, Executive Vice President and COO, International Division of Costco. <i>Management Insights</i> . New York Times (2024). How Costco Hacked the American Shopping Psyche https://www.nytimes.com/2024/08/20/dining/costco.html Optional: WSJ (June 7, 2013). Costco CEO Craig Jelinek Leads the Cheapest, Happiest Company in the World https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2013-06-06/costco-ceo-craig-jelinek-leads-the-cheapest-happiest-company-in-the-world?leadSource=uverify%20wall
After class Homework: Individual assignment: ○ Reflection on guest speaker John Gleason's sharing (< 300 words) ○		
Date	Topics	Required readings and videos (available on Canvas)
May 20 (Tuesday) 6:00-9:30pm	Week 8 International HRM – Global Talent Development Case analysis:	Pucik, Bjorkman, (2023). Development talent (Chapter 7 of the book <i>The Global Challenge</i> , pp. 245-277). Lu, Swaab, & Galinsky (2021). Global Leaders for Global Teams: Leaders with Multicultural Experiences Communicate and Lead More Effectively, Especially in Multinational Teams.

	Black & Decker-Eastern Hemisphere and the ADP Initiative (A) (Group 1 and Group 2) Guest speaker: Jerry Liu, Senior VP, China, TTH, https://our-company.dsm-firmenich.com/en/our-company.html Former CEO, Cargill China	Osland, J.S., Bird, A., Mendenhall, M., & Osland, A. (2006). Developing global leadership capabilities and global mindset: A review. Optional: Ng, K-Y., Van Dyne, L., & Ang, S. (2009). From Experience to Experiential Learning: Cultural Intelligence as a Learning Capability for Global Leader Development. AMLE, 8,511-526.
After class Homework: 1. Reflection on Jerry Liu's talk 2. Prepare cases: - o Global talent management at KONE (Group 3)		

Date	Topics	Required readings and videos (available on Canvas)
May 27 (Tuesday) 6:00-9:30pm	Week 9 Building a global Organization Case analysis: Global talent management at KONE (Group 3) Amazon goes Global 2020 (Group 4) Guest Speaker: Jack Xuan, Principal Product Manager at Amazon	The Lingua Franca Mandate: "ENGLISHNIZATION" (Chapter 1 of the book <i>The Language of Global Business</i>, pp. 13-26) Why Global Success Depends On Separating Language & Culture Tsedal Neeley TEDxCambridg https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=B8VoxpR08Vg Optional: L'Oreal masters multiculturalism. L'Oréal Masters Multiculturalism (hbr.org) Leaders with Lacqua: Jean-Paul Agon, L'Oreal Chairman & CEO https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WdFbGfZ9ux4
After class Homework: • Individual assignment: - o Self-assessment: International career inventory Prepare cases – Ellen Moore in Bahrain (Group 5) Satya Nadella at Microsoft (Group 6)		

Date	Topics	Required readings and videos (available on Canvas)
June 3 (Tuesday) 6:00- 9:30pm	Week 10 Journey to becoming a global manager and global leadership Challenges for women expats Case analysis: Ellen Moore in Bahrain (Group 5) Guest Speaker: Giselle Antoine Case discussion: Satya Nadella at Microsoft (Group 6)	Helen Deresky (2014). Managing expatriates (International Management pp. 278-288) Adler, N., & Gundersen, A. (2008). Coaching women for global managerial success. (International Dimension of OB: pp.297-304). Microsoft CEO Satya Nadella on creating a culture that fosters ideas https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6tyCydR30pg Satya Nadella: Microsoft's Products Will Soon Access Open AI Tools Like ChatGPT WSJ https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UNbyT7wPwk4 Optional: Den Hartog, D. N., House, R. J., et al. (1999). Culture Specific and Cross-culturally Generalizable Implicit Leadership Theories: Are Attributes of Charismatic/transformational Leadership Universally Endorsed? <i>Leadership Quarterly</i> , 10(2), 219-256.
After class Homework: Final Group Reflection Paper due on June 10		

Evaluation and Student Responsibilities:

Individual Assignments	30%
Group Projects	35%
Community Contribution	35%
Total	100%

The following grading scale will be used to determine final course grades:

% points	97-100	90-96	84-89	78-83	70-77	64-69	58-63	50-57	44-49	38-43	34-37	<34
Letter	A	A-	B+	B	B-	C+	C	C-	D+	D	D-	F
Decimal	3.9-4.0	3.5-3.8	3.2-3.4	2.9-3.1	2.5-2.8	2.2-2.4	1.9-2.1	1.5-1.8	1.2-1.4	0.9-1.1	0.7-0.8	0

This class is NOT graded on a curve. Historically, the median is 3.4-3.6.

I. Individual assignments (30%):

We will use cases extensively in this class to help you get a taste of the real-world cross-cultural management issues. Before the class discussion of each case, you will be given a list of questions to help you understand the case and think about the solutions to these questions. We will also have simulations and guest speakers in class, after which individual reflections are required. How much and how well you will learn and how successful the class discussions can be will heavily depend on how well you do your

individual assignments before and after class. Please consult Canvas under the "Individual assignments" tag for details.

II. Team Projects and case analysis (35%):

There are three group projects and one group case analysis for this class:

Team project 1: Strategies for group communication effectiveness + Revision (icEdge profile) (10%)

Team project 2: Group movie analysis (a movie related to a foreign culture) (10%)

Please select a foreign or U.S. movie that involves another culture other than the U.S. and then adopt the theoretical frameworks we discussed in class (e.g., Hall, Hofstede, Triandis, Trompenaars) to analyze the similarities and differences between that culture and the U.S. and discuss the **potential managerial implications**. Below is a potential movie list, you are welcome to choose your own:

Everything Everywhere All at Once (Asian Chinese)
CoCo (Mexico)
Kung Fu Panda (Hollywood production of Chinese values)
Crazy Rich Asians (Chinese- American)
Eat Drink Men Woman (Taiwan, China)
In the Mood for Love (Hong Kong)
Emily in Paris (American in France, TV show, Netflix)
Ted Lasso (American in UK, TV show, Paramount +)
Grand Maison Tokyo (Japan)
I Not Stupid (Singapore)
Monsoon Wedding (India)
My Big Fat Greek Wedding (US, Greece)
Parasite (S. Korea)
Shall We Dance (Japan)

Team project 3: Group reflection project (10%)

Team case analysis: 5%

III. Community Contribution (35%):

The efficient way to learn is to actively engage in your education. Therefore, I expect each of you to attend every class, to read assigned articles and cases and come to class ready to discuss them and to share your understanding, insights, and relevant experiences with your classmates. If you are unable to attend a session, please let me know as soon as possible so that we can make a plan together for how you'll cover what you missed.

Effective and worthwhile discussion participation includes contribution of comments that demonstrate knowledge and integration of course material, building on responses of others, and critical, but respectful analysis of others' comments. As such, your community contribution grade will be indexed in three ways: (1) the *frequency* of your contributions, (2) their *quality* (ability to draw on course materials and your own experience productively; ability to advance or sharpen discussion and debate; willingness to take risky or unpopular points of view; use of logic, precision, and evidence in making arguments; and going beyond the "I feel" level of introspection); and (3) the *professionalism* of your conduct (punctuality, preparedness, respecting other class members and their contributions, and refraining from conduct that is distracting).

Making Up a Class:

For those who have to miss the first class on April 1, you need to make a self-introduction video (2-minute) and upload it to Canvas in addition to other make-up work, indicated below.

For each missed class, please watch the recording of the class meeting and read the required readings. Do the related exercises if there are any (will be posted on Canvas). Write a single-spaced 1-page (font 11) response essay for the day you missed, on what you thought about the class, what you would have said in the class discussions, and your reactions to the required readings. Email that write-up to me (xpchen@uw.edu) within three days of the last class meeting.

Guideline for GAI Use

All assignments in this course will permit the use of generative artificial intelligence (GAI) tools such as ChatGPT and MS Copilot. You need to ensure that all information contained in the output does have a proper citation (e.g. a fact or data point should have the source identified). Violations of this policy will be considered academic misconduct.

Keep in mind that GAI tools have a known deficiency in “hallucinating” certain citations, therefore you need to verify that citations are genuine. It is each student’s responsibility to assess the validity and applicability of any GAI output that is submitted; you bear the final responsibility. We draw your attention to the fact that different classes at Foster could implement different AI policies, and it is the student’s responsibility to conform to expectations for each course.

Academic Misconduct:

WAC 478-1220-020 of the University of Washington Student Conduct Code states that students are expected to “Practice high standards of academic and professional honesty and integrity.” This means that students will not engage in activities like plagiarism, multiple submissions (submitting a paper for credit to more than once class), turning in a paper that you didn’t write, cheating on exams, or collaborating on individual assignments. In short, academic dishonesty WILL NOT BE TOLERATED in any form. Although you may discuss assignments outside of class, turning in identical assignments, copying off others during exams, looking at someone else’s exam, using past assignments or tests (other than what is posted on Canvas for common use) or any other form of academic dishonesty will result in a zero grade on the assignment and/or exam and could result in more severe penalties as allowed by University policy. Put even more succinctly: do your own work.

At the Foster School, we strive to promote an atmosphere that encourages “better than compliance.” You are a member of a learning community and expected to uphold the fundamental standards of honesty, respect and integrity. It is your responsibility to model these qualities and encourage others to do the same.

Access and Accommodations:

Your experience in this class is important to me. If you have already established accommodations with Disability Resources for Students (DRS), please communicate your approved accommodations to me at your earliest convenience so we can discuss your needs in this course.

If you have not yet established services through DRS, but have a temporary health condition or permanent disability that requires accommodations (conditions include but not limited to; mental health, attention-related, learning, vision, hearing, physical or health impacts), you are welcome to contact DRS at 206-543-8924 or uwdrs@uw.edu or disability.uw.edu. DRS offers resources and coordinates reasonable accommodations for students with disabilities and/or temporary health conditions. Reasonable accommodations are established through an interactive process between you, your instructor(s) and DRS. It is the policy and practice of the University of Washington to create inclusive and accessible learning environments consistent with federal and state law.

Religious Accommodations:

Washington state law requires that UW develop a policy for accommodation of student absences or significant hardship due to reasons of faith or conscience, or for organized religious activities. The UW's policy, including more information about how to request an accommodation, is available at Religious Accommodations Policy (<https://registrar.washington.edu/staffandfaculty/religious-accommodations-policy/>). Accommodations must be requested within the first two weeks of this course using the Religious Accommodations Request form.

Appendix: Cases and Assessments

Week 1:

- Documentary film: *American Factory*, 2019

Week 2:

- icEdge communication style assessment (<http://icEdge.com>)

Week 3:

- Group icEdge assignment worksheet
- Netflix going global (Chapter 10 of the book *No Rules Rules*)
- Case - Leading across Cultures at Micheline (A)(B)

Week 4:

- Alpha-Beta simulation

Week 5:

- Case -Unpacking the layers of diversity & inclusion in multicultural teams

Week 6: Group Movie Project presentation

Week 7: Costco guest speaker: John Gleason

Week 8:

- Case - Black & Decker-Eastern Hemisphere and the ADP Initiative (A) (Debate: Group 1, Group 2)
- Guest speaker: Jerry Liu (based in Shanghai)

Week 9:

- Survey - International career inventory
- Case – Global talent management at KONE (Group 3)
- Case – Amazon goes global 2020 (Group 4)
 - Amazon guest speaker: Jack Xuan

Week 10:

- Case - Ellen Moore in Bahrain (Group 5)
 - Guest speaker: Giselle Antoine
- Case – Satya Nadella: A growth mindset for Microsoft (Group 6)

Additional Books:

Beyond Cultures. By Edward Hall, 1976.

What Isn't Being Said. By Wendi Adair, Nancy Buchan, Xiao-Ping Chen, & Leigh Anne Liu, 2023.

Developing Global Executives. By Morgan McCall & George Hollenbeck, 2002.

Kiss, Bow, Or Shake Hands: The Bestselling Guide to Doing Business in More Than 60 Countries.

Second Edition by Terri Morrison and Wayne A. Conaway, 2006.

Riding the Waves of Culture: Understanding Diversity in Global Business by Fons Trompenaars and Charles Hampden-Turner, 2012.

The Culture Map: Breaking Through the Invisible Boundaries of Global Business by Erin Meyer, 2014.

Leadership of Chinese Private Enterprises: Insights and Interviews. By Anne Tsui, Yingying Zhang, & Xiao-Ping Chen, 2017.

The Language of Global Success: How a Common Tongue Transforms Multinational Organizations. By Tsedal Neeley, 2017.